

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Legal Secretary position at your Reading firm, as advertised through Reed. With over a year of hands-on experience supporting fee earners in a busy private practice setting and a strong background in preparing legal documents, managing case files and coordinating across matters with competing deadlines, I am well placed to provide the comprehensive secretarial and administrative support your team needs.

During my year-long placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I worked directly alongside solicitors and partners across two disputes teams — International Arbitration and Real Estate Disputes. Day to day, I prepared and formatted procedural documents, drafted correspondence, organised electronic case files via iManage, assisted with court filings and managed deadlines across several live matters simultaneously. I also prepared electronic hearing bundles and supported skeleton arguments and court materials, giving me direct experience of the document-heavy workflows that legal secretarial work requires.

In my current role as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I manage matters from instruction through to submission — drafting correspondence, preparing application packs and document schedules, maintaining confidential records and meeting firm deadlines. Working with high caseloads across welfare, employment, housing and family matters has sharpened both my organisational discipline and my ability to prioritise competing demands without losing attention to detail.

I am accurate, proactive and comfortable working at pace. I understand that legal secretarial support is not peripheral to a fee earner's work — it is what keeps matters running — and I take that responsibility seriously.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to your team. Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva